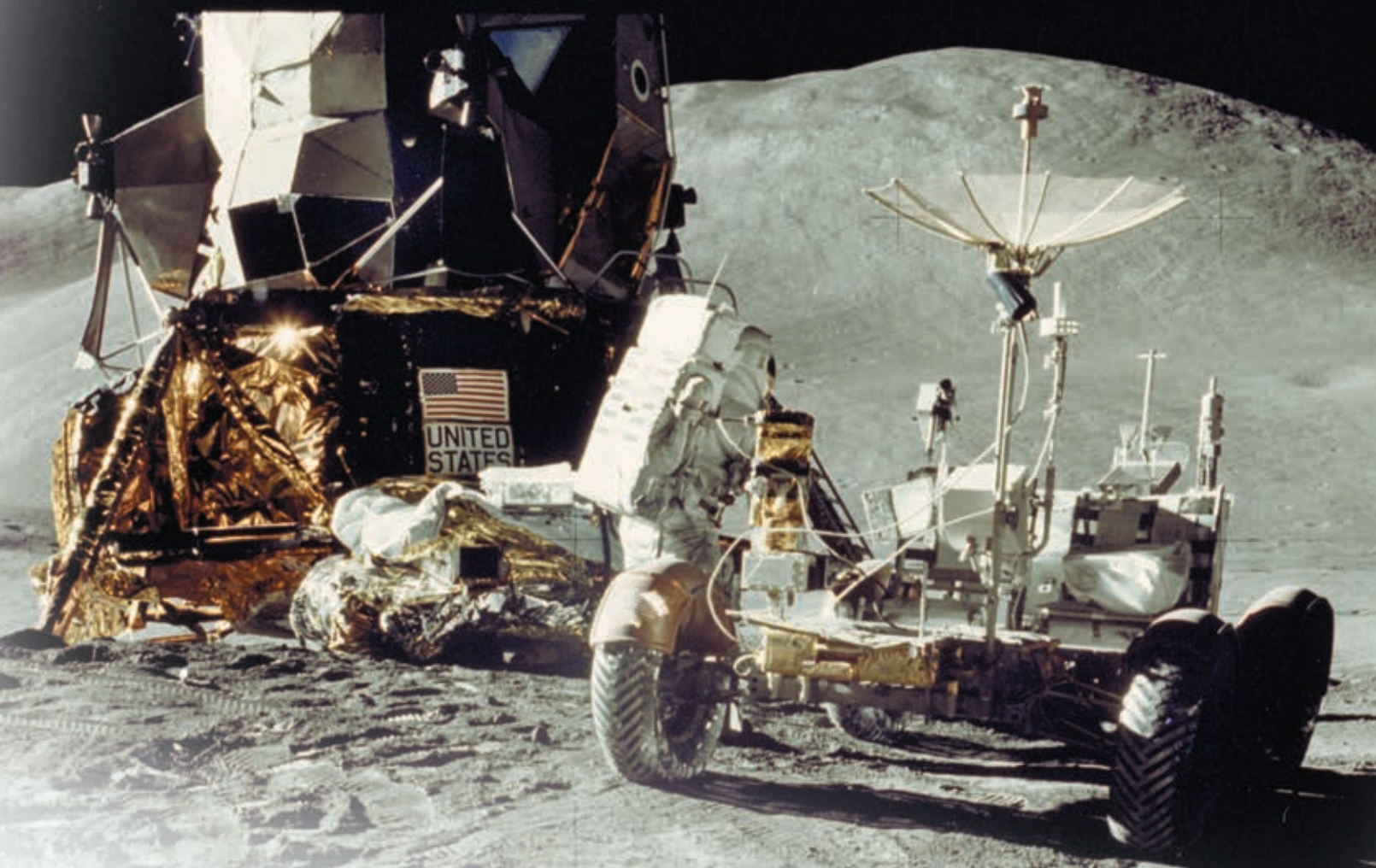




LUNAR ROVER

Apollo 15 was the first mission to benefit from the Lunar Rover. Unfolded after landing, this battery-powered automobile had a separate motor for each of its four wheels. It carried antennae and cameras to keep the astronauts in touch with mission control.

the Apollo program. It read: "Here man completed his first exploration of the Moon... May the spirit of peace in which we came be reflected in the lives of all mankind."

As the Apollo program drew to a close, with waning public interest, there was an inevitable feeling of anticlimax. Many Americans at the time were inclined to be critical of the amount of

money and effort that had been expended on a project with so little relevance to the pressing problems confronting life on Earth.

Yet the achievements of the Apollo project were incontestable. Twelve men had walked on the Moon. They had brought back to Earth a total of 842lb (379kg) of lunar rock for geologists to study. Each mission had left scientific

instruments on the Moon that contributed to our understanding of the Moon's structure and its history. Moreover, the Apollo program had led to valuable technological progress in many areas.

And it had been more than simply a great feat of technological innovation and organization. It had been an heroic venture, an affirmation of the human will, always to go further, always beyond.

FAREWELL TO THE MOON

Filmed by a television camera left behind on the Lunar Rover, the ascent stage of the lunar module Challenger lifts off from its descent platform, carrying astronauts Gene Cernan and Harrison Schmitt to rendezvous with the Apollo 17 command module on December 14, 1972. After that day, no humans set foot on the Moon's surface for the rest of the 20th century.

